

# INTERDISCIPLINARY POLITICAL ANALYSIS

THE INTEGRATED POLITICAL QUESTION → DEFINITIONS, ARGUMENT SPINE AND → BOUNDARIES, THINKERS AND DISCIPLINARY → ILLUSTRATIONS AND THE FIVE-DISCIPLINE → TRAP REPAIR, CROSS-LINKS, REVISION → ANTHROPOLOGY, LAW AND GEOGRAPHY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

## THE INTEGRATED POLITICAL QUESTION

THE INTEGRATED POLITICAL QUESTION

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] THE CHAPTER ARGUES THAT SINGLE-DISCIPLINE APPROACHES ARE PARTIAL

[2] POLITICAL SCIENCE STUDIES POLITICS AS A SOCIAL PROCESS

[3] INTERDISCIPLINARY INQUIRY WIDENS PERSPECTIVE, HELPS VERIFY POLITICAL CLAIMS

[4] FOR UPSC, THIS TOPIC PREVENTS SHALLOW ANSWERS THAT

THE INTEGRATED POLITICAL QUESTION IS BEST PRESENTED THROUGH ITS

EXAM ROUTE

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- The Integrated Political Question
- [1] The chapter argues that single-discipline approaches are partial, whereas an interdisciplinary approach seeks an integrated view of politics.
- (PDF p.146)

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [2] Political science studies politics as a social process, so it must use findings, theories and models from
- (PDF pp.136-137)
- [3] Interdisciplinary inquiry widens perspective, helps verify political claims through other social sciences, and also enables political science
- (PDF p.137)

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- [4] For UPSC, this topic prevents shallow answers that explain democracy, state
- action or mass behaviour through only law, only morality or only economics.
- SYNTHESIS → The Integrated Political Question is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — The Integrated Political Question is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

01

STAGE 01

## DEFINITIONS, ARGUMENT SPINE AND PURPOSEFUL BORROWING

DEFINITIONS, ARGUMENT SPINE AND PURPOSEFUL BORROWING

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] GAUBA BEGINS BY TREATING SOCIAL SCIENCES AS RELATED

(PDF P.136)

[2] HE INSISTS THAT POLITICAL INQUIRY SHOULD BORROW FROM

[3] EMPIRICAL ORIENTATION, BEHAVIOURAL ANALYSIS AND SYSTEMS ANALYSIS PUSHED

[4] POLITICAL SCIENCE THEREFORE USES DATA, THEORIES AND MODELS

DEFINITIONS, ARGUMENT SPINE AND PURPOSEFUL BORROWING IS BEST PRESENTED

### CENTRAL FOCUS

Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing

[1] Gauba begins by treating social sciences as related disciplines dealing

with common human problems, which makes interdisciplinarity especially suitable to politics.

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing
- [1] Gauba begins by treating social sciences as related disciplines dealing
- with common human problems, which makes interdisciplinarity especially suitable to politics.
- (PDF p.136)

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [2] He insists that political inquiry should borrow from other disciplines purposefully, always to understand political problems, not
- (PDF p.137)
- [3] Empirical orientation, behavioural analysis and systems analysis pushed political science toward other social sciences because real politics
- (PDF pp.138-139)
- [4] Political science therefore uses data, theories and models from history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy. (PDF pp.139-146)

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SYNTHESIS → Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing is best presented
- through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Definitions, Argument Spine and Purposeful Borrowing is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

02

STAGE 02

## BOUNDARIES, THINKERS AND DISCIPLINARY AUTONOMY

BOUNDARIES, THINKERS AND DISCIPLINARY AUTONOMY

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] INTERDISCIPLINARY VS RANDOM BORROWING

GAUBA WARNS THAT EXPANSION ACROSS DISCIPLINES MUST BE PURPOSEFUL

[2] EMPIRICAL VS NORMATIVE

EMPIRICAL INQUIRY ASKS WHAT IS; NORMATIVE INQUIRY ASKS WHAT

[3] POLITICAL SCIENCE VS POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY

SCIENTIFIC-BEHAVIOURAL STUDIES HELP FIND FACTS AND TOOLS, WHILE POLITICAL

### CENTRAL FOCUS

Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy

[1] Interdisciplinary vs random borrowing: Gauba warns that expansion across disciplines must be purposeful and

[2] Empirical vs normative: empirical inquiry asks what is; normative inquiry asks what ought to

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

[3] POLITICAL SCIENCE VS POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY

SCIENTIFIC-BEHAVIOURAL STUDIES HELP FIND FACTS AND TOOLS, WHILE POLITICAL

CENTRAL FOCUS

Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy

[1] Interdisciplinary vs random borrowing: Gauba warns that expansion across disciplines must be purposeful and

[2] Empirical vs normative: empirical inquiry asks what is; normative inquiry asks what ought to

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy
- [1] Interdisciplinary vs random borrowing: Gauba warns that expansion across disciplines must be purposeful and well-conceived. (PDF p.137)
- [2] Empirical vs normative: empirical inquiry asks what is; normative inquiry asks what ought to be. (PDF p.138)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [3] Political science vs political philosophy: scientific-behavioural studies help find facts and tools, while political philosophy helps determine goals of public policy.
- (PDF pp.145-146)
- [4] Governance boundary: governance explains delivery mechanisms; this topic uses governance-like evidence only when it sharpens a political concept.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SYNTHESIS → Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy is best presented through
- its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Boundaries, Thinkers and Disciplinary Autonomy is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

03

STAGE 03

ILLUSTRATIONS AND THE FIVE-DISCIPLINE MATRIX

ILLUSTRATIONS AND THE FIVE-DISCIPLINE MATRIX

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] GAUBA SAYS A POLITICAL SCIENTIST ASSESSING WHETHER DEMOCRACY

[2] LABOUR-MANAGEMENT RELATIONS OR CROWD PSYCHOLOGY SHOULD BE STUDIED

[3] POLITICAL DEVELOPMENT REQUIRES UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL MOBILIZATION AND VALUE

[4] POLITICAL COMMUNICATION, PROPAGANDA, CHARISMATIC LEADERSHIP AND PUBLIC OPINION

ILLUSTRATIONS AND THE FIVE-DISCIPLINE MATRIX IS BEST PRESENTED THROUGH

EXAM ROUTE

| SYSTEM / DOCTRINE                                                                                                                | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                                                                                                                 | EVALUATION / TRAP                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CENTRAL FOCUS                                                                                                                    | [2] Labour-management relations or crowd psychology should be studied politically only when they illuminate their impact on politics. (PDF p.137)    | its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.                                                |
| Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix                                                                                     | [3] Political development requires understanding social mobilization and value change, not merely constitutions or legal forms. (PDF p.140)          | EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment. |
| [1] Gauba says a political scientist assessing whether democracy will be sustained may need data on literacy, income (PDF p.139) | [4] Political communication, propaganda, charismatic leadership and public opinion formation draw directly on political psychology. (PDF pp.144-145) |                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                                                  | SYNTHESIS → Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix is best presented through                                                                   |                                                                                                                        |

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix
- [1] Gauba says a political scientist assessing whether democracy will be sustained may need data on literacy, income
- (PDF p.139)

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- [2] Labour-management relations or crowd psychology should be studied politically only when they illuminate their impact on politics. (PDF p.137)
- [3] Political development requires understanding social mobilization and value change, not merely constitutions or legal forms. (PDF p.140)
- [4] Political communication, propaganda, charismatic leadership and public opinion formation draw directly on political psychology. (PDF pp.144-145)
- SYNTHESIS → Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix is best presented through

EVALUATION / TRAP

- its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Illustrations and the Five-Discipline Matrix is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

04

STAGE 04

TRAP REPAIR, CROSS-LINKS, REVISION AND SOURCES

TRAP REPAIR, CROSS-LINKS, REVISION AND SOURCES

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] FOR ECONOMIC MECHANISMS, REFER OUTWARD TO THE ECONOMY

[2] FOR DELIVERY AND INSTITUTIONAL PERFORMANCE, REFER OUTWARD TO

[3] DEFINE INTERDISCIPLINARITY AS PURPOSEFUL USE OF MORE THAN

[4] SHOW WHY EMPIRICAL ORIENTATION, BEHAVIOURALISM AND SYSTEMS ANALYSIS

TRAP REPAIR, CROSS-LINKS, REVISION AND SOURCES IS BEST PRESENTED

EXAM ROUTE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources
- [1] For economic mechanisms, refer outward to the Economy module in prose rather than reproducing technical economics here.
- [2] For delivery and institutional performance, refer outward to the Governance module

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- in prose rather than turning this topic into an administrative note.
- [3] Define interdisciplinarity as purposeful use of more than one discipline. (PDF p.136)
- [4] Show why empirical orientation, behaviouralism and systems analysis pushed political science outward. (PDF pp.138-139)
- SYNTHESIS → Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources is best presented

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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technical economics here.

[2] For delivery and institutional performance, refer outward to the Governance module

(PDF pp.138-139)

• SYNTHESIS → Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources is best presented

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Trap Repair, Cross-Links, Revision and Sources is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

05

STAGE 05

ANTHROPOLOGY, LAW AND GEOGRAPHY

ANTHROPOLOGY, LAW AND GEOGRAPHY

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] GAUBA'S CHAPTER (PDF PP.141-146) FOREGROUNDS HISTORY, ECONOMICS, SOCIOLOGY

[2] EXAM USE

IF THE QUESTION SPECIFICALLY ASKS FOR AN "INTERDISCIPLINARY" ANSWER

[3] LAW/JURISPRUDENCE AS A DATA SOURCE

DISTINCT FROM THE LEGAL APPROACH TO STUDYING POLITICS (ALREADY

[4] POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY

CENTRAL FOCUS

Anthropology, Law and Geography

[1] Gauba's chapter (PDF pp.141-146) foregrounds history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy.

A complete interdisciplinary answer should also be able to place anthropology, law and geography on

[2] Exam use: if the question specifically asks for an "interdisciplinary" answer without naming

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

CENTRAL FOCUS

Anthropology, Law and Geography

[1] Gauba's chapter (PDF pp.141-146) foregrounds history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy.

A complete interdisciplinary answer should also be able to place anthropology, law and geography on the same map,

[2] Exam use: if the question specifically asks for an "interdisciplinary" answer without naming

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

disciplines, a strong 15/20-mark response should be able to name at least six to

seven disciplines (history, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, anthropology, law, geography) and give one distinct

contribution for each, rather than repeating the same five from Gauba's chapter alone.

[3] Law/jurisprudence as a data source: distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under §8's traditional approaches), the interdisciplinary use of law supplies political analysis with constitutional text, statutes

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

and judicial reasoning as primary evidence of how authority is formally allocated and constrained.

[4] Political geography: studies the spatial dimension of politics — territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.

SYNTHESIS → Anthropology, Law and Geography is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Anthropology, Law and Geography is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

06

STAGE 06

BORROWED MODELS AND NAMED REDUCTIONISMS

BORROWED MODELS AND NAMED REDUCTIONISMS

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] GAUBA NAMES SPECIFIC BORROWED MODELS POLITICAL SCIENCE HAS

ELITE THEORY, BASE-SUPERSTRUCTURE ANALYSIS (FROM MARXIAN POLITICAL ECONOMY), STRUCTURAL-FUNCTIONALISM

[2] REDUCTIONISM, NAMED PRECISELY

EACH BORROWED MODEL RISKS A SPECIFIC REDUCTIONISM IF USED

[3] GAUBA'S OWN CORRECTIVE APPLIES TO EACH

BORROWING MUST REMAIN PURPOSEFUL AND POLITICS-CENTRED; A BORROWED MODEL

CENTRAL FOCUS

Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms

[1] Gauba names specific borrowed models political science has drawn from other disciplines: elite theory

(PDF pp.139-140)

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

CENTRAL FOCUS

Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms

[1] Gauba names specific borrowed models political science has drawn from other disciplines: elite theory, base-superstructure analysis (from

(PDF pp.139-140)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

[2] Reductionism, named precisely: each borrowed model risks a specific reductionism if used alone —

[3] Gauba's own corrective applies to each: borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred

a borrowed model sharpens political analysis only so long as the political question, not the donor discipline's own priorities, stays in view.

(PDF pp.137, 146)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

[4] Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly

(PDF p.140)

SYNTHESIS → Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS — Borrowed Models and Named Reductionisms is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

07

STAGE 07

OBJECTIONS AND INTEGRATION WITHOUT MERGER

OBJECTIONS AND INTEGRATION WITHOUT MERGER

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] "DISCUSS THE INTERDISCIPLINARY CHARACTER OF POLITICAL SCIENCE"

REQUIRES THE DEFINITION OF INTERDISCIPLINARITY, AT LEAST THREE DISCIPLINES

[2] END WITH GAUBA'S CONCLUSION

SINGLE-DISCIPLINE APPROACHES ARE PARTIAL; INTEGRATION IS NECESSARY, BUT MERGER

[3] YET THE CONCLUSION IS NOT MERGER INTO ONE

[4] SEYMOUR MARTIN LIPSET

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

CENTRAL FOCUS

Objections and Integration Without Merger

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

[3] Yet the conclusion is not merger into one master science

the integrated approach keeps politics central while using all relevant disciplines for verification and understanding

REPLY / RESIDUAL

SYNTHESIS → Objections and Integration Without Merger is best presented through

its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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OBJECTIONS AND INTEGRATION WITHOUT MERGER

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] "DISCUSS THE INTERDISCIPLINARY CHARACTER OF POLITICAL SCIENCE"

REQUIRES THE DEFINITION OF INTERDISCIPLINARITY, AT LEAST THREE DISCIPLINES

[2] END WITH GAUBA'S CONCLUSION

SINGLE-DISCIPLINE APPROACHES ARE PARTIAL; INTEGRATION IS NECESSARY, BUT MERGER

[3] YET THE CONCLUSION IS NOT MERGER INTO ONE

[4] SEYMOUR MARTIN LIPSET

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Objections and Integration Without Merger
- [1] "Discuss the interdisciplinary character of political science" → requires the definition of interdisciplinarity, at least three
- disciplines with one contribution each, and the integration-without-merger conclusion — not just a list of subject names.
- [2] End with Gauba's conclusion: single-discipline approaches are partial; integration is necessary, but merger is not. (PDF p.146)

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- [3] Yet the conclusion is not merger into one master science
- the integrated approach keeps politics central while using all relevant disciplines for verification and understanding.
- (PDF p.146)
- [4] Seymour Martin Lipset: political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and
- (PDF p.140)

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- SYNTHESIS → Objections and Integration Without Merger is best presented through
- its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS → Objections and Integration Without Merger is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

08

STAGE 08

CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION

CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] POLITICAL-ECONOMY LENS

DEBATES ON ECONOMIC LIBERALISATION, WELFARE-SCHEME DESIGN OR FEDERAL FISCAL

[2] POLITICAL-SOCIOLOGY LENS

CASTE, COMMUNITY AND REGIONAL IDENTITY'S ROLE IN INDIAN PARTY

[3] POLITICAL-GEOGRAPHY LENS

INDIA'S FEDERAL REORGANISATION OF STATES AND CONTINUING REGIONAL/RESOURCE-SHARING DISPUTES

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Cautious Indian Application
- [1] Political-economy lens: debates on economic liberalisation, welfare-scheme design or federal fiscal transfers illustrate how
- political theory uses economic evidence to analyse policy conflict — cite as a type of
- application, without asserting specific unverified figures, scheme names or years unless independently confirmed.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [2] Political-sociology lens: caste, community and regional identity's role in Indian party mobilisation
- and political culture is a standard illustrative anchor for the sociology-politics link —
- use only as a general, well-known pattern, not with specific unverified electoral statistics.
- [3] Political-geography lens: India's federal reorganisation of states and continuing regional/resource-sharing disputes (river-water disputes, hill-state demands) illustrate how
- route exact dates, tribunal names or case detail to the

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Polity/Geography modules rather than asserting them here.
- [4] Political science studies politics as a social process, so it must use findings, theories and models from
- (PDF pp.136-137)
- SYNTHESIS → Cautious Indian Application is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS → Cautious Indian Application is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

09

STAGE 09

DIRECTIVE DECODING AND MARK-SCALED ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

DIRECTIVE DECODING AND MARK-SCALED ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] "EXAMINE THE CONTRIBUTION OF [A NAMED DISCIPLINE] TO

SINGLE-DISCIPLINE DIRECTIVE

GIVE THAT DISCIPLINE'S SPECIFIC CONTRIBUTION, ONE BORROWED MODEL OR

[2] "DISCUSS THE INTERDISCIPLINARY CHARACTER OF POLITICAL SCIENCE"

REQUIRES THE DEFINITION OF INTERDISCIPLINARITY, AT LEAST THREE DISCIPLINES

[3] "CAN POLITICAL SCIENCE BE STUDIED INDEPENDENTLY OF OTHER

CENTRAL FOCUS

Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

[1] "Examine the contribution of [a named discipline] to political analysis" → single-discipline directive: give

that discipline's specific contribution, one borrowed model or example, and its limit if used alone.

[2] "Discuss the interdisciplinary character of political science" → requires the definition of interdisciplinarity, at

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture
- [1] "Examine the contribution of [a named discipline] to political analysis" → single-discipline directive: give
- that discipline's specific contribution, one borrowed model or example, and its limit if used alone.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [2] "Discuss the interdisciplinary character of political science" → requires the definition of interdisciplinarity, at least three
- disciplines with one contribution each, and the integration-without-merger conclusion — not just a list of subject names.
- [3] "Can political science be studied independently of other social
- sciences?" → requires the objection/reply on subject-matter dissolution (§15.1) explicitly.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- [4] Thesis: political science needs other disciplines' evidence and models but keeps the political question central.
- SYNTHESIS → Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture is best presented
- through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS → Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

10

STAGE 10

MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR

MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR

CENTRAL FOCUS

[1] POLITICAL SCIENCE STUDIES POLITICS AS A SOCIAL PROCESS

[2] INTERDISCIPLINARY INQUIRY WIDENS PERSPECTIVE, HELPS VERIFY POLITICAL CLAIMS

[3] THE CHAPTER ARGUES THAT SINGLE-DISCIPLINE APPROACHES ARE PARTIAL

[4] FOR UPSC, THIS TOPIC PREVENTS SHALLOW ANSWERS THAT

MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR IS BEST PRESENTED THROUGH

EXAM ROUTE

10

STAGE 10 MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR

- MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR CENTRAL FOCUS [1] POLITICAL SCIENCE STUDIES POLITICS AS A SOCIAL PROCESS [2] INTERDISCIPLINARY INQUIRY WIDENS PERSPECTIVE, HELPS VERIFY POLITICAL CLAIMS [3] THE CHAPTER ARGUES THAT SINGLE-DISCIPLINE APPROACHES ARE PARTIAL [4] FOR UPSC, THIS TOPIC PREVENTS SHALLOW ANSWERS THAT MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR IS BEST PRESENTED THROUGH EXAM ROUTE

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

[1] Political science studies politics as a social process, so it must use findings, theories

(PDF pp.136-137)

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair
- [1] Political science studies politics as a social process, so it must use findings, theories and models from
- (PDF pp.136-137)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [2] Interdisciplinary inquiry widens perspective, helps verify political claims through other social sciences, and also enables political science
- (PDF p.137)
- [3] The chapter argues that single-discipline approaches are partial, whereas an interdisciplinary approach seeks an integrated view of politics.
- (PDF p.146)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- [4] For UPSC, this topic prevents shallow answers that explain democracy, state
- action or mass behaviour through only law, only morality or only economics.
- SYNTHESIS → MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS → MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

11

STAGE 11 PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE

- PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE CENTRAL FOCUS [1] GAUBA SAYS A POLITICAL SCIENTIST ASSESSING WHETHER DEMOCRACY [2] A GOOD UPSC ANSWER ON WELFARE POLITICS CAN [3] GAUBA'S CHAPTER (PDF PP.141-146) FOREGROUNDS HISTORY, ECONOMICS, SOCIOLOGY [4] EXAM USE IF THE QUESTION SPECIFICALLY ASKS FOR AN "INTERDISCIPLINARY" ANSWER PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE IS BEST PRESENTED THROUGH

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

[1] Gauba says a political scientist assessing whether democracy will be sustained may need data

(PDF p.139)

[2] A good UPSC answer on welfare politics can therefore move from economic scarcity

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice
- [1] Gauba says a political scientist assessing whether democracy will be sustained may need data on literacy, income
- (PDF p.139)
- [2] A good UPSC answer on welfare politics can therefore move from economic scarcity,

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- to class/group conflict, to mass attitudes, and finally to philosophical evaluation of justice.
- [3] Gauba's chapter (PDF pp.141-146) foregrounds history, economics, sociology, psychology and philosophy.
- A complete interdisciplinary answer should also be able to place anthropology, law and geography on the same map,
- [4] Exam use: if the question specifically asks for an "interdisciplinary" answer without naming
- disciplines, a strong 15/20-mark response should be able to name at least six to

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- seven disciplines (history, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, anthropology, law, geography) and give one distinct
- contribution for each, rather than repeating the same five from Gauba's chapter alone.
- SYNTHESIS → PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.
- EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM ROUTE → define precisely → explain the mechanism → test the limit → conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SYNTHESIS → PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

- OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT 1. ONE-SCREEN ADVANCED MAP 2. SCOPE, ASSUMPTIONS AND CONCEPTUAL BOUNDARY 3. DIRECT-BOOK ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION 4. DEFINITIONS AND DISTINCTIONS 5. THINKER-BY-THINKER POSITIONS 6. COMPETING PERSPECTIVES 7. INTERNAL DEBATES AND CRITICISMS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- 1. One-screen advanced map
- 2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary
- 3. Direct-book argument reconstruction
- 4. Definitions and distinctions

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- 5. Thinker-by-thinker positions
- 6. Competing perspectives
- 7. Internal debates and criticisms
- 8. Comparative matrix

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- 9. Application without current-affairs dependence
- 10. UPSC answer-engine prompts
- 11. Cross-links and exclusions
- 12. Factual-risk checks

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.